

Part B: Prevention Checklist

Stay Safe Online: A Guide for Indian Students

Lock Your Profiles: Make use of the 'Lock Profile' feature on Facebook and Instagram to ensure that only verified friends have access to your posts and photographs.

Two-Factor Authentication (2FA): Make sure that 2FA is enabled for all your social media and email accounts to prevent 'account takeover' for impersonations.

The 'Screen-Before-Share' Rule: Never reveal your One-Time Password (OTP), even if the person posing as a 'friend' or 'college admin' asks for it.

UPI Safety (Financial): Never forget that by entering your UPI PIN, you are essentially allowing money to LEAVE your account. You will never be required to pay any fees to receive money.

Secure UPI Apps (Financial): Make sure that you have a different fingerprint lock for your UPI apps (GPay, PhonePe, etc.) and do not use your birth year as your UPI PIN.

Verify Direct Messages: When a friend asks for urgent money via a direct message, make sure to give them a call and verify the request. Deepfake technology and/or hacked accounts are often used for these 'emergency' scams.

Report, Don't Retaliate: When bullied online, do not retaliate. Instead, take a screenshot of the evidence and immediately block the user.

Use Official Reporting Channels: In case of any kind of cybercrime, immediately report the case to the following official Indian government websites and helpline numbers:

Portal: cybercrime.gov.in

Helpline: Dial 1930 (24/7 National Cybercrime Helpline).